

MULTIPLES

When a number is multiplied by any whole number the result (product) is called a multiple. For example, the first six multiples of the number 2 are 2, 4, 6, 8, 10, and 12. This is because $2 \times 1 = 2$, $2 \times 2 = 4$, $2 \times 3 = 6$, $2 \times 4 = 8$, $2 \times 5 = 10$, and $2 \times 6 = 12$.

MULTIPLES OF 3

$$3 \times 1 = 3$$

$$3 \times 2 = 6$$

$$3 \times 3 = 9$$

$$3 \times 4 = 12$$

$$3 \times 5 = 15$$

first five
multiples
of 3

MULTIPLES OF 8

$$8 \times 1 = 8$$

$$8 \times 2 = 16$$

$$8 \times 3 = 24$$

$$8 \times 4 = 32$$

$$8 \times 5 = 40$$

first five
multiples
of 8

MULTIPLES OF 12

$$12 \times 1 = 12$$

$$12 \times 2 = 24$$

$$12 \times 3 = 36$$

$$12 \times 4 = 48$$

$$12 \times 5 = 60$$

first five
multiples
of 12

Common multiples

Two or more numbers can have multiples in common. Drawing a grid, such as the one on the right, can help find the common multiples of different numbers. The smallest of these common numbers is called the lowest common multiple.

24

Lowest common multiple

The lowest common multiple of 3 and 8 is 24 because it is the smallest number that both multiply into.



multiples of 3



multiples of 8



multiples of 3 and 8

► Finding common multiples

Multiples of 3 and multiples of 8 are highlighted on this grid. Some multiples are common to both numbers.

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20
21	22	23	24	25	26	27	28	29	30
31	32	33	34	35	36	37	38	39	40
41	42	43	44	45	46	47	48	49	50
51	52	53	54	55	56	57	58	59	60
61	62	63	64	65	66	67	68	69	70
71	72	73	74	75	76	77	78	79	80
81	82	83	84	85	86	87	88	89	90
91	92	93	94	95	96	97	98	99	100